

The Aspiration Prayer from the Wish-Fulfilling Jewel Tradition of Noble Avalokiteśvara

Toh 812 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སྐྱ་རས་གཟགས་དབང་ཕྱག་ཡིད་བཞིན་གཞི་གཞི་རོ་བའུ་རིམ་པ་ལས་སྐྱོ་ལམ་འབད་བ།

The Aspiration Prayer from the Wish-Fulfilling Jewel Tradition of the Noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord (Tibetan: Ārya Avalokiteśvara Yishin Norbu'i Tokpa le Mönlam Jungwa) is a short devotional prayer addressed to the bodhisattva of compassion. It opens with homage to the buddha Amitābha, the Three Jewels, Avalokiteśvara, and the bodhisattva Mahāsthāmaprāpta, and then petitions Avalokiteśvara, through the practitioner's recollection of him and recitation of his name, to pacify the unbearable sufferings of oneself and all sentient beings and to cut their continuity. A colophon-like line at the start associates the prayer with the Poṭala tradition, named for the mountain abode of Avalokiteśvara, and the Sanskrit title is not clearly given in the source lines. It is Toh 812 in the Kangyur, where it is classed among the tantra texts, and belongs to the body of aspirational and invocatory works devoted to Avalokiteśvara.

Here ends the prayer of aspiration drawn from the Poṭala tradition.

The noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord, the Aspiration Prayer from the Wish-Fulfilling Jewel Tradition.

I pay homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha Amitābha. I pay homage to the Three Jewels. I pay homage to the noble Avalokiteśvara. I pay homage to the bodhisattva, the great being endowed with great compassion, Mahāsthāmaprāpta, the one of great power.

Venerable Avalokiteśvara, you who are endowed with great compassion, please give your attention to me. Noble Lord of Compassion, through my recollecting you and calling your name, may all unbearable suffering of mine and of all sentient beings be pacified and its continuity be cut.

I pay homage to the venerable Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion. Noble Lord of Compassion, through my recollecting you and calling your name, may all the fears and harms, and all hostile adversaries, of mine and of all sentient beings be cut off at the root.

I pay homage to the venerable Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion. Noble Lord of Compassion, through my recollecting you and calling your name, may all the karma and afflictions of mine and of all sentient

beings, all unwholesome phenomena, and everything born of the work of Māra, be purified and released.

I pay homage to the venerable Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion. Noble Lord of Compassion, through my recollecting you and calling your name, may I and all sentient beings constantly see the face of the venerable Avalokiteśvara, and may every aspiration we have made quickly be fulfilled.

I pay homage to the venerable Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion. Noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of Compassion, through my recollecting you and calling your name, may I and all sentient beings see directly the face of whichever noble ones we wish to see, and may all that we request of the supreme and holy ones likewise be accomplished.

I pay homage to the venerable Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion. Noble Lord of Compassion, through my recollecting you and calling your name, may I and all sentient beings obtain great power to bring benefit and happiness to all who are destitute and helpless in the world.

I pay homage to the venerable Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion. Noble Lord of Compassion, through my recollecting you and calling your name, may whatever harms of fire, water, wind, and the like, or of great famine-stricken wildernesses, afflict many beings in the world, be pacified and be no more for those in distress.

I pay homage to the venerable Avalokiteśvara, endowed with great compassion. Noble Lord of Compassion, through my recollecting you and calling your name, when the great fear of death and of passing from this world to the next draws near for me and for other sentient beings, may we see your face directly, noble Lord of Compassion, and may you grant us great relief.

And may I and other beings, at the time of death, not be overcome by the afflictions, but be mindful of the selflessness of phenomena, firm in a measureless awakening mind, with an undaunted mind, endowed with unobstructed confidence. May every painful feeling be completely pacified, and may we die with mindfulness firmly established.

In all future lives, may we be born at the feet of the noble Avalokiteśvara, recollect our past lives, and, endowed with the perfect awakening mind, please the noble Lord of Compassion and others, and...

May all this come to be endowed with the power of fulfillment, just as it has been taught. Just as the Lord of Compassion himself has perfected, spontaneously, the gateway of liberation of great compassion, and has become of one taste with the compassion of all the buddhas, so may it be for us.

Just as the Lord of Compassion brings sentient beings to full maturity, purifies the buddha fields, and fully perfects all the qualities of a buddha, so may I and all sentient beings likewise bring all sentient beings to full maturity, completely purify all buddha fields, and fully perfect all the qualities of the buddha fields.

Just as, by recollecting and reciting the name of the noble Avalokiteśvara, the Lord, the very embodiment of the compassion of the buddhas and bodhisattvas of the three times, may the names of all the Victors of the three times together with their spiritual heirs be recited and honored, so may it be for us. And just as, by recollecting, reciting the name of, and making offerings to the noble Avalokiteśvara, the very nature of the compassion of all the Victors of the three times together with their heirs, may the practice of the skillful means of great compassion arise without interruption toward all sentient beings who have become objects of great compassion.

As long as I wander in saṃsāra,
for as long as I take a body,
for that long may I make offerings to the Protector,
and may I gather the accumulation of bodily practice.

As long as I wander in saṃsāra,
for as long as words arise in me,
for that long may I recite the name of the Protector,
and may I gather the accumulation of practice of speech.

As long as I wander in saṃsāra,
for as long as my mind is engaged,
for that long may I recollect the Protector,
and may I gather the accumulation of practice of mind.

Thus, by relying on the Lord of Compassion
through body, speech, and mind,
may my body, speech, and mind be free of fault
and complete in every excellent quality.

Thus, through body, speech, and mind,
by constantly joining with the body, speech, and mind
of the Lord of Compassion,
Avalokiteśvara, Lord of Compassion,
the sole refuge of hope for the three realms of existence,
whose qualities are beyond thought,
may I too become accomplished in just such a way,
and may I fulfill the hopes of the three realms of existence.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Nama āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisattvāya mahāsattvāya
mahākāruṇikāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ cakravartī cintāmaṇi mahāpadme ruru tiṣṭha
jvala ākarṣaya hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

The root mantra is complete.

Oṃ padme cintāmaṇi jvala hūṃ. This is the essence mantra.

Oṃ bharata padme hūṃ. This is the near-essence mantra.

Oṃ maṇi

Translator's Notes

- The passage is cut off mid-sentence at the end, so the final clause is left unfinished in the translation. The colophon-like opening line (Poṭala) belongs to the end of a preceding text and is rendered as such. "Poṭala" is read from the Tibetan; it likely alludes to Potalaka, the abode of Avalokiteśvara, though the exact textual reference is uncertain. In the line about the "great wilderness," the Tibetan reads "wilderness of famine" (mu ge); I rendered it as famine-stricken wilderness, which fits the list of harms from elements. The phrase "chos bdag med pa" is rendered as the selflessness of phenomena, following the standard doctrinal sense.
- The passage breaks off mid-mantra at the end, so the final mantra, beginning "Oṃ maṇi," is left incomplete exactly as in the source. The Sanskrit of the root mantra follows the Tibetan transliteration, which has some irregularities, such as "nam" for "nama"; I have normalized it lightly. In the second verse the Tibetan phrase for "as long as words arise" is slightly compressed; I have rendered it by sense. The phrase "sole refuge of hope for the three realms of existence" renders the three srid, meaning the three realms.

Colophon

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spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.